

CARLOS ALCARAZ

TENNIS



Carlos Alcaraz did not have the ideal start to 2025 as he went down to Novak Djokovic in the Australian Open quarterfinal, a match he could have won. But from February, the 22-year-old Spaniard began putting together the best season of his young career so far. Jannik Sinner, his main rival who successfully defended his title in Melbourne, was forced to sit out for three months due to a doping ban.

Alcaraz gained crucial ranking points during that period to close in on the No. 1 ranking the Italian had held since June 2024.

A month after beating Sinner in straight sets in the Italian Open final — Sinner's first event after the ban — Alcaraz faced him again in the summit clash at Roland Garros. The Spaniard came back from two sets down and saved three championship points to defeat the Italian 4-6, 6-7(4), 6-4, 7-6(3), 7-6(10-2) in perhaps the greatest French Open final ever, lasting five hours and 29 minutes in Paris.

The duo met in the finals at Wimbledon and the U.S. Open as well. While Sinner took revenge for the Paris heartbreak with a four-set triumph at the grass Major, Alcaraz dethroned the Italian in clinical fashion at Flushing Meadows. In 2022, Alcaraz had become the youngest-ever World No. 1 after his maiden U.S. Open title. Three years later, after the same event, he regained the top spot in the ATP rankings.

The Spaniard won a total of eight titles and finished the season with a win-loss record of 71-9. He also showed improvements on indoor hard courts by reaching the final of the ATP Finals in Turin, where he lost to Sinner. Nevertheless, he finished the year as World No. 1. He was also selected as the winner of the 2025 Stefan Edberg Sportsmanship Award for his exemplary behaviour on and off the court.

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